

my_theme. The name of the folder should correspond with the name of the theme you want to create and should be unique in the theme folder.

To develop a theme in WordPress, you must have the HTML document ready with you. Place this HTML file with its assets (CSS and JS) in the theme directory.

Breaking up the HTML template into PHP files

The next step involves creating four PHP files. Using the HTML file, we have to create *index.php*, *header.php*, *sidebar.php* and *footer.php* by breaking the HTML file into four parts and saving them in the same theme folder. Just create one more file in the same directory *style.php* for styling purposes.

How these files work is shown below.

header.php: This file will contain the code for the header section of the theme.

index.php: This is the main file for the theme. It will contain the code for the 'Main Area' and will specify where the other files will be included.

sidebar.php: This file will contain the information about the sidebar.

footer.php: This file will handle your footer.

style.css: This file will handle the styling of your new theme.

Now let's take a closer look at each file and what it should contain.

header.php

```
<html>
<head>
<title>My Theme</title>
<link href="<?php echo get_template_directory_uri(); ?>/css/header.css" rel="stylesheet" type="text/css" />
<script language="javascript" type="text/javascript" src="<?php echo get_template_directory_uri(); ?>/jquery-1.8.3.js"></script>
</head>
<body>
<div id="wrapper">
<div id="header">
<h1>HEADER</h1>
</div>
```

index.php

```
<?php get_header(); ?>
<div id="main">
<div id="content">
<h1>Main Area</h1>
</div>
```

```
<?php get_sidebar(); ?>
</div>
```

```
<?php get_footer(); ?>
```

sidebar.php

```
<div id="sidebar">
<h2 >Sidebar Area</h2>
</div>
```

footer.php

```
<div id="footer">
<h1>FOOTER</h1>
</div>
</div>
</body>
</html>
```

We can fetch other parts of our HTML template into *index.php* by calling a few functions like:

1. *get_header()* to call *header.php*
2. *get_footer()* to call *footer.php*
3. *get_sidebar()* to call *sidebar.php*
4. *get_template_directory_uri()*: This function is used to provide the full path of the theme directory to access the style sheet and scripts.
5. *the_title()*: This function is used to show the title of the post.

To fetch the post in our HTML theme, we have to use the WordPress predefined function:

```
<?php if (have_posts()) : while (have_posts()) : the_post(); ?>
<h1><?php the_title(); ?></h1>
<h4>Posted on <?php the_time('F jS, Y') ?></h4>
<p><?php the_content(__('(more...)')); ?></p>
<hr> <?php endwhile; else: ?>
<p><?php _e('Sorry, no posts matched your criteria.');
```

It will fetch all the contents and the titles of the posts, along with the time when these were posted. We have to place the above code in our HTML template, accordingly. 

By: Gaurav Kakran

The author is senior associate, Web development at Fierce Hound Media Pvt Ltd, Gurgaon. He is fond of developing Web applications in PHP, and can be reached at gauravkakran7@gmail.com